Official C.M. Four Square Tournament

1. Game Rules

a. This tournament will follow the Official C.M. Ruleset

2. Tournament Format

a. Overview

i. Players will start with a seeding round with everyone

ii. Players will be divided into groups of 4 and will compete against each other

iii. The top 2 players from each group in Round 1 will move up to the next round

iv. The rounds will continue until there are 4 players left

v. This will be the final round, and the top player will be the champion

b. Seeding

i. There will be a 20 minute seeding round in which all players will participate in

ii. 4 players' names will be drawn randomly one at a time and they will be placed in square 1-4, respectively

iii. There will be a 5 second serving timer

iv. Timer will be stopped for any long discussion, ball retrieval, etc. Ref's discretion

v. The scoring will follow the standard tournament scoring (see section 2c)

vi. At the end of the 20 minutes, the players will be ranked from highest eliminations to lowest, with birthdays closest to Jan 1 from the current date being tie breakers

c. Scoring

i. Players receive one point for every valid elimination they cause

1. An elimination is credited when a player hits the ball and another player is ruled out as a direct result of the hit

2. Example situations of credited eliminations

a. The ball bounces twice in their square

b. The ball is hit before it bounces in their square

c. The hit is invalid

d. The ball is hit by the incorrect player

3. Example situations of non-credited eliminations

a. The server/returner faults twice

b. The player illegally interferes with gameplay in a manner that would rule them out

4. Crediting eliminations is ultimately referee discretion

5. On a valid hit, if the ball goes out of bounds with no other player contact, the offending player loses one point

a. If the ball is touched by another player before going out of bounds, then it is scored as an elimination point

6. At the end of each round (excluding the first round of each match) players will receive points based on what square they are in.

a. 4th square – 4 points

b. 3rd square – 3 points

c. 2nd square – 2 points

d. 1st square – 1 points

7. If a player is found to not be playing in the "spirit" of the four square tournament, at the referee's discretion, they will be penalized by one point

a. This includes unnecessarily aggressive moves, direct hits aiming at the body, harassment, etc.

b. Players may appeal this ruling, with then everyone in attendance taking a vote on if the player is guilty, thus losing a point.

d. Gameplay

i. Players will be divided into groups of 6 going down the order

1. I.e. Rank 1-6 will be a group, Rank 7-16 will be a group

ii. Starting position in each square is determined on seed

iii. Each group will play 24 rounds

iv. If there are more than 6 people in a group, there will be an additional 4 rounds per extra person

v. At the end of the rounds, the top 2 scoring players from each group will advance to the next round

vi. The tie breaker being their original seed

vii. The remaining players will then be put into new groups of 4 based on their original seed

viii. If there are a number of players that will not fit evenly into groups of 4 (i.e. 6 or 10), the top players will be put into groups of 4 until there are an uneven number of players left.

ix. The remaining amount will be placed into other groups at random

x. The groups will then play 16 rounds, with an additional 4 rounds per extra person, over 4 people

xi. This pattern will continue until there are 4 players left

xii. The champion of this round will be crowned the winner